METRIC

A-A-59841A
16 September 2026
SUPERSEDING
A-A-59841
30 October 2009

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ASCENDER, MECHANICAL

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description (CID) by all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This CID covers the requirements for the mechanical ascender which are used to assist personnel in ascending a rope.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The mechanical ascenders shall be furnished in the following types:

Type I – Ascender, left handed
Type II – Ascender, right handed

2.1 Sizing. The ascender mechanical maximum weight shall be no more than 170 grams. The ascender shall be as light-weight as possible, while meeting the standards described in the description.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS. The construction of the ascender shall conform in all respects to Drawing 3-3-0113. The ascender action shall have top and bottom attachment holes for use with a typical carabiner for hauling. There shall be a molded hand grip. A safety release latch shall be incorporated so the cam will only release the rope when the safety release latch is activated, and the cam is sprung back out of the operating position. The ascender safety release trigger (latch) shall operate freely without jamming. The rope groove shall be sized to accommodate 8 millimeter – 11 millimeter diameter rope. The tooth design of the cam shall be self-cleaning. The ascender shall have a weight not to exceed 0.36 pounds (165 grams). The ascender design shall provide ease of use with the typical combat gloves while meeting the standards described in the description

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, and any other data that may improve this document should be sent to trpsptctstandardiz@dla.mil.

AMSC N/A FSC 4240

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release. Distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T10:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1 Color. The ascenders shall be provided with a low reflectance finish and provide low contrast with typical use terrain unless otherwise specified in the solicitation or contract order.

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Basic material. The main body shall be constructed of aluminum.

3.2.2 Locking cam material. The locking cam shall be constructed of steel.

3.2.3 Grip. The molded over grip shall be plastic.

3.2.4 Rivets and springs. The rivets and springs shall be steel.

3.3 Tests. The ascender shall meet the current International Mountaineering and Climbing Federation Union International des Associations d'Alpinisme – (UIAA) Standard 126 & EUROPEAN STANDARD EN 567, or equivalent if updated or modified.

3.4 Workmanship. The finished ascender shall conform to the quality of product established by this document. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the contractor's own quality assurance standards and the quality assurance standards defined in the technical data in the solicitation and/or contract.

3.5 Service life. The ascender shall have no unexpected material or component failures during a continuous one-year cycle. The ascender shall have no unexpected material or component failures during periodic use over a five-year period.

3.6 Labels, barcoding and instruction slip. If applicable, all labeling, barcoding and instruction slip requirements shall be as specified in the solicitation or contract (see 7.2).

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. Unless otherwise specified, the offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered, recycled, bio based, and environmentally preferable materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403, 23.404(b) of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR), or the sustainable acquisition of EO 13834; as applicable. (see 7.1.2 and 7.1.3).

5. PRODUCT CONFORMANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Market acceptability. The finished ascender offered must have been sold to the government or commercial market.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T10:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3 End item inspection procedures.

5.3.1 Visual examination. Each ascender shall be examined for the following defects as listed in Table I:

TABLE I. End item examination

Examine	Defect Description
Cam	Spring not functional
Construction	Not free of burrs, rough spots, slivers, flat areas or projections Any component loose, missing or not specified type Any component fractured, slit, punctured, dented, bowed, malformed or damaged Marking etched or indented, contains rough or sharp edges
Labels/barcoding/instruction slip (if applicable)	Incorrect, illegible, omitted or misplaced.
Marking	Omitted, missing information or illegible

5.4 Dimensional examination. The finished ascender shall conform to the dimensions specified in the drawing. Any dimension that is not within the established tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The sample unit shall be one ascender.

5.5 Acceptance criteria. Acceptance criteria shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order (see 7.2).

6. PACKAGING. The preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 7.2).

7. NOTES.

7.1 Sources of Government documents.

7.1.1 Copies of Government documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil.

7.1.2 Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR) are available online at https://aquisition.gov.

7.1.3 EPA information is available online at https://www.epa.gov and EO 13834 information is available online at https://www.fedcenter.gov/.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T10:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

7.1.4 DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK SOLDIER CENTER

3-3-0113 Ascender, Mechanical

(Copies of this drawing required by contractors in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the Contracting Officer)

7.2 Sources of non-Government documents.

7.2.1 EUROPEAN STANDARD (EN)

EN 567: Mountaineering Equipment – Rope Clamps – Safety Requirements and Test Methods

(Copies are available online at www.bsi-global.com or from BSI British Standards, Customer Services 389 Chiswick High Road London W4 4AL United Kingdom)

INTERNATIONAL MOUNTAINEERING AND CLIMBING FEDERATION
UNION INTERNATIONALE DES ASSOCIATIONS D'ALPINISME (UIAA)

UIAA Safety Standard 126 Mountaineering and Climbing Equipment, Rope Clamps

(Copies are available online at http://www.theuiaa.org or the Union Internationale Des Associations D'Alpinisme (UIAA) Monbijoustrasse 61 Postfach CH-3000 Bern 23 Switzerland)

NFPA 2500 Standard on Organizational Capabilities for Technical Search and Rescue and Life Safety Rope and Equipment for Emergency Services

(Copies are available online at https://www.nfpa.org/codes-and-standards/nfpa-2500-standard-development/2500.)

7.3 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this CID.
b. When required, labeling, barcoding and instruction slip (see 3.6).
c. Acceptance criteria (see 5.5).
d. Packaging (see 6).

7.4 Known source.

Petzl America
info@petzl.com
(+1) 801 926 1500

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T10:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

7.5 Key words.

Clamps
Climbing
Mountaineering
Rope

MILITARY INTERESTS:

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:
GSA – FAS

Custodian:
Army - GL
Navy- MC

Preparing activity:
DLA-CT

(Project 4240-2026-002)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change, you should verify the currency of the information above using ASSIST at https://assist.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T10:29Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.